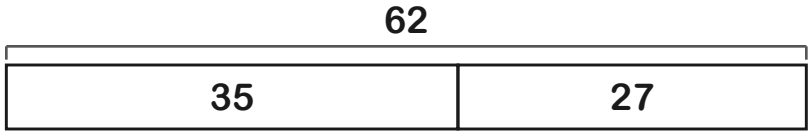
Two-Step Word Problems

Draw a bar. Find the missing part. Then do the next step.

Part + part = whole

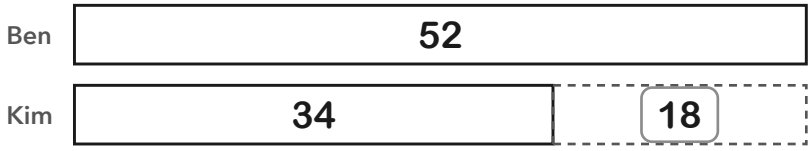
Mia has 35 red beads and 27 blue beads. How many beads?



$35 + 27 = 62$

Compare: how many more?

Ben has 52 cards. Kim has 34 cards. How many more does Ben have?



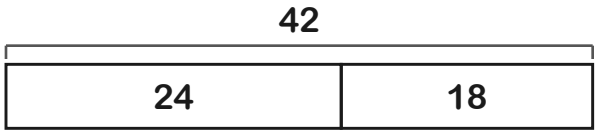
$34 + 18 = 52$

Jump up from 34 to 52.

Two steps: the first answer is a part of the second bar

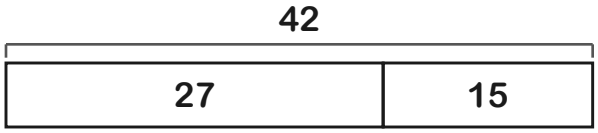
Leo has 24 stickers. He gets 18 more. Then he gives 15 away. How many now?

Step 1



$24 + 18 = 42$

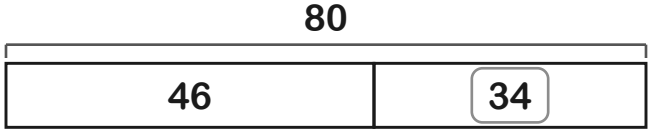
Step 2



$42 - 15 = 27$

Your turn!

80 kids. 46 are boys. How many girls?



Read. Draw.
Write. Answer.

For teachers

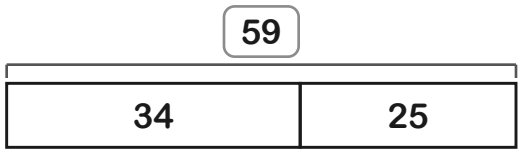
Goal: solve one- and two-step word problems within 100 with a bar model (2.OA.1). Ask "What is the whole? What are the parts?" "Fewer" can mean add. In two steps, the first answer is a part of the second bar.

Two-Step Word Problems: Practice

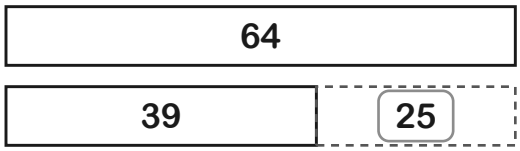
Read. Draw the bar. Write the number sentence. Answer.

Part 1 Read the bar Find the number that goes in the box.

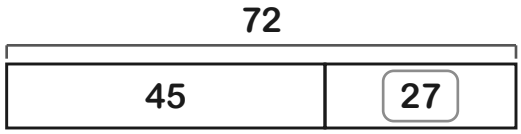
1)



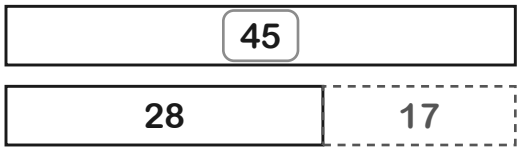
2)



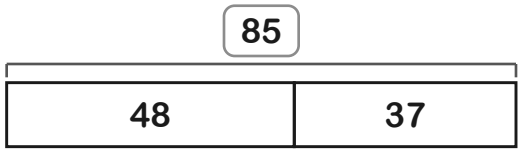
3)



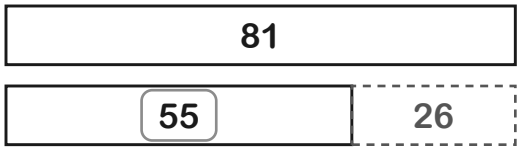
4)



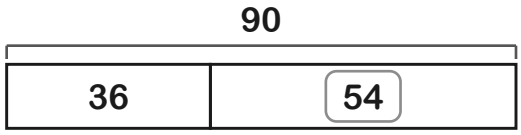
5)



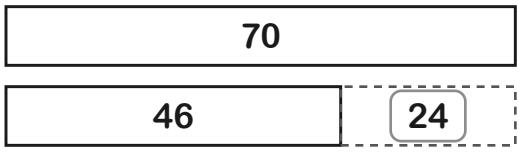
6)



7)

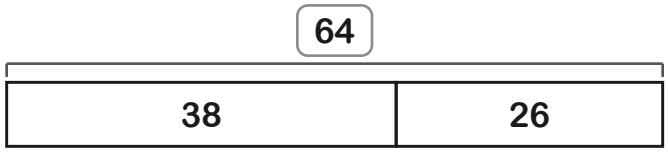


8)



Part 2 Part and part The bar is drawn for you.

9) Ava has 38 red beads and 26 blue beads. How many beads does she have?



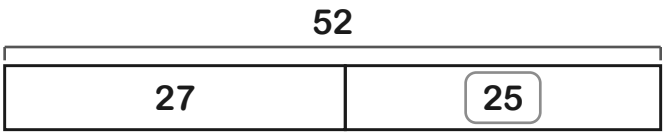
Number sentence 38 + 26 = 64

Answer 64 beads

Two-Step Word Problems: Practice (continued)

Part 2 Part and part (continued)

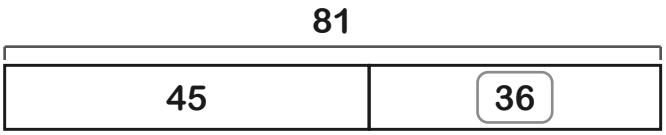
10) There are 52 kids at the park. 27 kids are on the swings. The rest are in the sandbox. How many are in the sandbox?



Number sentence 52 − 27 = 25

Answer 25 kids

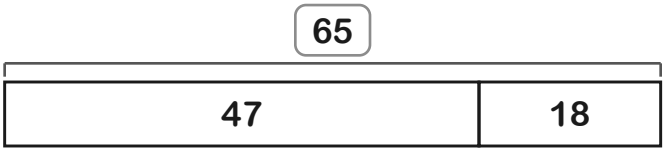
11) Leo picked 45 apples. Then he picked some more. Now he has 81 apples. How many more did he pick?



Number sentence 45 + 36 = 81

Answer 36 apples

12) Some birds sat in a tree. 18 birds flew away. Now 47 birds are left. How many birds were there at first?

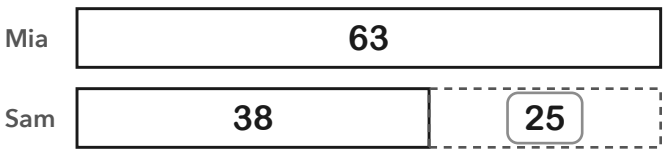


Number sentence 47 + 18 = 65

Answer 65 birds

Part 3 Compare The longer bar is the bigger number.

13) Mia has 63 stickers. Sam has 38 stickers. How many more stickers does Mia have?



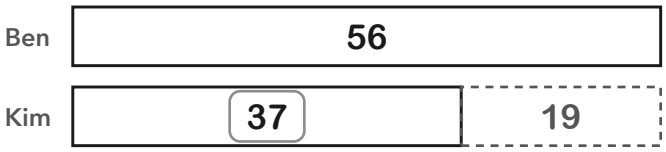
Number sentence 38 + 25 = 63

Answer 25 stickers

Two-Step Word Problems: Practice (continued)

Part 3 Compare (continued)

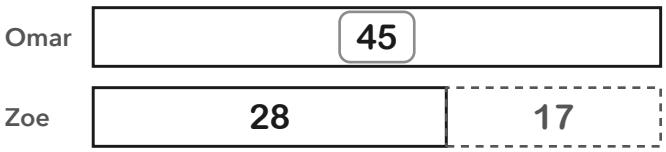
14) Ben scored 56 points. Kim scored 19 fewer points than Ben. How many points did Kim score?



Number sentence 56 − 19 = 37

Answer 37 points

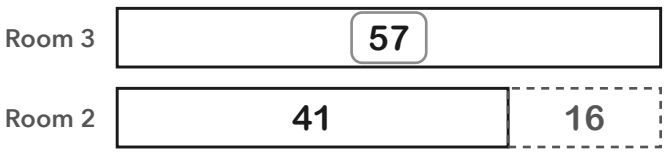
15) Zoe read 28 books. Omar read 17 more books than Zoe. How many books did Omar read?



Number sentence 28 + 17 = 45

Answer 45 books

16) Room 2 has 41 kids. That is 16 fewer kids than Room 3. How many kids are in Room 3?



Number sentence 41 + 16 = 57

Answer 57 kids

Part 4 Draw the bar Draw it yourself. Is the whole missing, or a part?

17) A box has 75 crayons. 48 of them are broken. How many crayons are not broken?

Number sentence 75 − 48 = 27

Answer 27 crayons

Draw or show your work

Two-Step Word Problems: Practice (continued)

Part 4 Draw the bar (continued)

18) Nia had some shells. She found 26 more. Now she has 60 shells. How many did she have at first?

Number sentence $60 - 26 = 34$

Answer **34** shells

Draw or show your work

19) Jay has 37 cards. Kai has 29 more cards than Jay. How many cards does Kai have?

Number sentence $37 + 29 = 66$

Answer **66** cards

Draw or show your work

20) A train has 92 seats. 55 seats are full. How many seats are empty?

Number sentence $92 - 55 = 37$

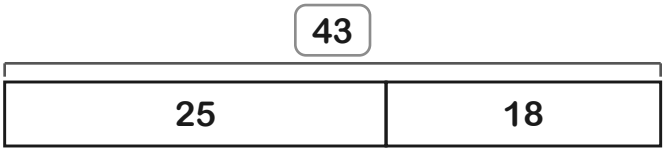
Answer **37** seats

Draw or show your work

Part 5 Two steps The bars are drawn for you. Step 1 helps with step 2.

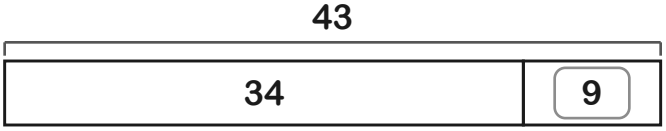
21) Ava had 25 stickers. She got 18 more. Then she gave 9 away. How many stickers does she have now?

Step 1



Step 1 $25 + 18 = 43$

Step 2



Step 2 $43 - 9 = 34$

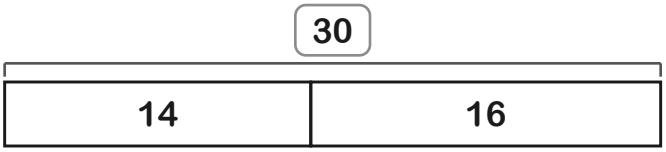
Answer **34** stickers

Two-Step Word Problems: Practice (continued)

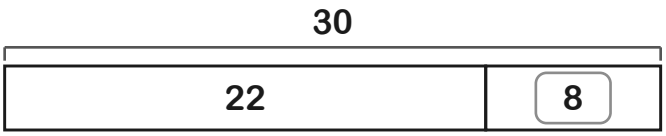
Part 5 Two steps (continued)

22) A class has 14 boys and 16 girls. Then 8 kids go home. How many kids are left?

Step 1



Step 2



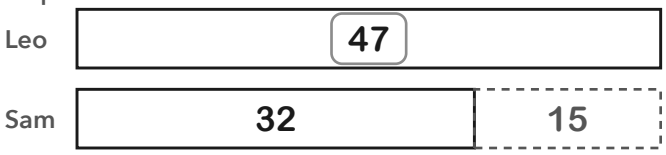
Step 1 14 + 16 = 30

Step 2 30 − 8 = 22

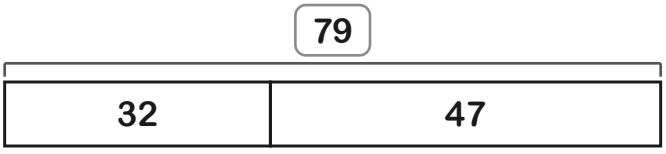
Answer **22** kids

23) Sam has 32 marbles. Leo has 15 more than Sam. How many marbles do they have together?

Step 1



Step 2



Step 1 32 + 15 = 47

Step 2 32 + 47 = 79

Answer **79** marbles

Two-Step Word Problems: Practice (continued)

Part 6 Two steps on your own Draw a bar for each step.

24) A baker made 40 rolls in the morning and 35 in the afternoon. She sold 58. How many rolls are left?

Draw the bars

Step 1 40 + 35 = 75

Step 2 75 − 58 = 17

Answer 17 rolls

25) Kim had 50¢. She bought a pencil for 25¢ and an eraser for 15¢. How much money is left?

Draw the bars

Step 1 25¢ + 15¢ = 40¢

Step 2 50¢ − 40¢ = 10¢

Answer 10¢

Two-Step Word Problems: Practice (continued)

Part 6 Two steps on your own (continued)

26) There were 36 kids on a bus. At the first stop, 12 got off. At the next stop, 9 got on. How many kids are on the bus now?

Draw the bars

Step 1 $36 - 12 = 24$

Step 2 $24 + 9 = 33$

Answer **33** kids

27) Mia read 23 pages on Monday and 19 pages on Tuesday. Her book has 60 pages. How many pages are left?

Draw the bars

Step 1 $23 + 19 = 42$

Step 2 $60 - 42 = 18$

Answer **18** pages

Two-Step Word Problems: Practice (continued)

Part 6 Two steps on your own (continued)

28) Challenge: Ben has 28 cards. Kai has 9 more than Ben. Zoe has 5 fewer than Kai. How many cards does Zoe have?

Draw the bars

Step 1 **28 + 9 = 37**

Step 2 **37 − 5 = 32**

Answer **32** cards

Part 7 Remember? Problems from earlier packets.

29) **503 − 268 =** 235

30) **quarter to 9 =** 8:45

31) **45¢ + 45¢ =** 90¢

32) **6 thirds =** 2 **wholes**

33) **half of 64 =** 32

34) **406 − 179 =** 227

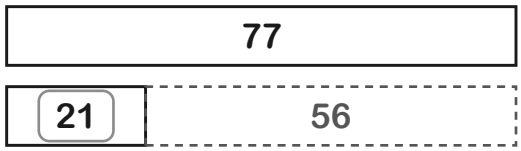
Check-In: Two-Step Word Problems

Show what you know. No help this time.

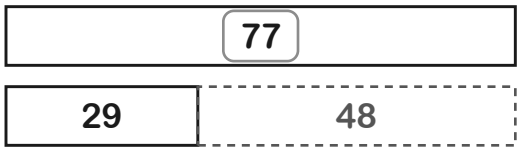
Mastery: 5 of 6 (80%)

Part 1 Read the bar Find the number that goes in the box.

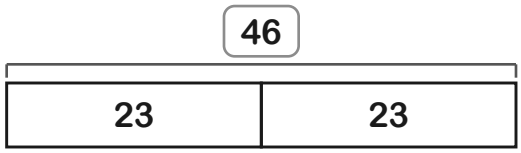
1)



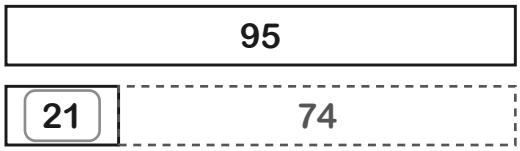
2)



3)



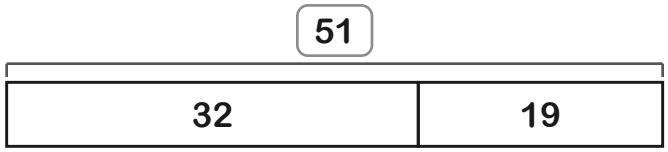
4)



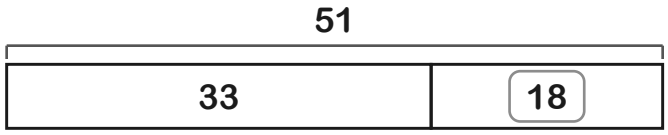
Part 2 Two steps

5) Jay had 32 cards. Jay got 19 more, then gave 18 away. How many cards are left?

Step 1



Step 2



Step 1 32 + 19 = 51

Step 2 51 − 18 = 33

Answer **33** cards

Part 3 One step Draw a bar if it helps.

6) Sam has 56 seeds and gives 25 away. How many seeds does Sam have left?

56 − 25 = 31

Answer **31** seeds